

Understanding E-Governance

Professor Dr. Md .Nurul Amin
Department of Public Administration
Jahangirnagar University

Section 1: What is Governance?

World Bank defined (1993) governance as “the method through which power is exercised in the management of a country’s political, economic and social resources for development”.

Governance ≠ Government

Governance = decision-making + implementation + accountability

Actors:

government, private sector, civil society, citizens

Good governance principles:

Transparency

Participation

Accountability

Efficiency

Inclusiveness

Examples: The way government is delivering services including-

- Passport delivery
- Land mutation
- Social safety net disbursement
- Local government services (trade license, holding tax)

Section 2: What is E-Governance?

Definitions:

Use of ICT to improve governance

Making government efficient, transparent, accessible, and citizen-centric.

Dimensions of E-Governance:

1. G2C – Services for citizens (birth registration, application tracking, etc.)
2. G2B – Services for businesses (TIN, VAT, licensing)
3. G2G – Government-to-government coordination (Nothi, Doptor)
4. G2E – Employee services (HRMIS, leave management)

Core components:

- People
- Processes
- Technology
- Policies

Section 3: Evolution of E-Government

Global Milestones:

- 1990s: First government websites
- 2000s: Online portals, e-tax filing
- 2010s: Digital identity + interoperability frameworks
- 2020s: Digital public infrastructure (DPI), AI government, paperless govt.

UN E-Government Development Index

What it measures:

- Online service index
- Telecom infrastructure index
- Human capital index

Global Leaders:

- Estonia,
- Singapore,
- UAE,
- Denmark,
- South Korea

Section 4: Bangladesh's Journey to E-Governance

Key Phases:

1. Digital Bangladesh 2021
2. Creation & work of a2i
3. UDC / Digital Centers in all unions
4. myGov, Nothi, ekPay, Surokkha, SDG Tracker

5. Smart Bangladesh 2041 vision

Platforms introduced:

- NESS (National e-Service System is a centralized Service Delivery platform of Bangladesh)
- National Portal Framework
- District e-service system
- Doptor
- Nothi
- UBID (Unique Business Identification) platform

Section 5: Why Do Governments Adopt E-Governance?

Benefits:

- Reduced corruption (audit trails, transparency)
- Faster service delivery
- Lower administrative burden

- Lower cost & less paperwork
- Data-driven decision making
- Convenience & accessibility
- Better disaster management (real-time data systems)
- Risks / Challenges:
- Legacy systems
- Lack of digital skill among govt officials
- Cybersecurity threats
- Policy gaps
- Low-quality infrastructure
- Resistance to change

Section 6: Four Pillars / Layers of E-Governance

Introduce a simple layered model:

- Front-End Service Layer: Portals, apps, kiosks, chatbots
- Application & Platform Layer: Nothi, myGov, UBID, LISF
- Data & Interoperability Layer : API gateways, shared registries
- Core Infrastructure Layer: Cloud, network, identity (NID), security

Section 7: Raising questions ?

- Which public services should Bangladesh digitize next?
- Are people in rural areas benefiting from digital services? Why/why not?
- What is your experience with govt digital services (passport, BRTA, UDC, etc.)?